negative about Pakistan. The serial Homeland also had unpleasant contents pertaining to Pakistan.

The battered image created problems for Pakistanis at home and abroad. Job opportunities for Pakistanis in the Middle East were being increasingly curtailed. It badly affected the economy of the country, as remittances from overseas Pakistanis amounting to about $14 billion were a substantial support to Pakistan's economy.

Usually Pakistanis faced tough treatment at foreign airports. It seemed that the green passport was devalued and visas were not issued easily. Obtaining a visa to not only Western countries but also the Middle Eastern Muslim countries became a tough task. For example, Pakistanis were completely banned in Kuwait, and even the families and newborns of those employed in Kuwait were denied a visa.

A Pakistani based in Kuwait narrated an incident: 'I remember once my sister got stuck at the immigration in Kuwait airport, they were not letting her out. I spoke to one of the security personnel to help. It was humiliating as he informed me for Pakistanis we cannot help.'

Western and other airlines stopped operating in Pakistan. Leading airlines, including British Airways, Singapore Airlines, Lufthansa and Malaysia Airlines had scaled back their operations since 2008 in part due to concerns related to security of their employees. 'This is as bad as it can get for us,' said a senior official of Civil Aviation Authority (CAA) responsible for encouraging foreign carriers to come and use Pakistan as a stopover destination. 'When it comes to poor law and order, all our efforts fail.' The attacks on Peshawar and Karachi airports in 2012 and 2014, respectively, compelled Emirates and Etihad Airways to suspend their flights. Only 19 foreign carriers came to Pakistan. Other than the airlines originating from Gulf countries, the only notable carrier was Cathay Pacific.

The aviation industry had also been hit by a stagnant growth in passenger traffic of around 16 million domestic and international travellers as deteriorating security undermined all prospects of the allied tourism and hospitality industry. The number of tourists declined due to the law and order situation.

After the terrorist attack on the Sri Lankan cricket team in Lahore in March 2009, cricket teams from other countries stopped visiting Pakistan over security concerns, depriving Pakistanis of enjoying international matches of their most favourite sport in Pakistan.